

In the next lesson I recommend loading \$40 in Anthropic credits **if you want to use Claude models for the best results through API**, but this is **not required**.

Watch the previous lesson "Before You Begin: Free & Paid AI Model Options" first to see all your options, including free ones.

If you already have a ChatGPT subscription, I show how to connect it in the "Installing OpenClaw Locally" lesson earlier in this section and in the "Adding API Keys, Smart Routing & Free Fallback" lesson in Section 3.

For the cheapest option with good results, I also cover free and cheap models like MiniMax and Kimi through OpenRouter in the "Free & Cheap Models" lesson in Section 3.